



PSAC 2025

Marathi

Subject code: **P190**

Examiners' Report

Introduction

The Primary School Achievement Certificate (PSAC) is an annual assessment which is administered by the Mauritius Examinations Syndicate for Grade 6 learners. The paper comprises nine constructed questions which meet the aims and objectives of the National Curriculum Framework (NCF) for primary education.

The Marathi assessment evaluates three principal language competencies;

- Reading comprehension 40 %
- Grammar and vocabulary 30%
- Writing 30 %

General comments

In 2025 a total of 103 candidates sat for the examination. Among them 79 candidates passed the examinations, and 24 candidates could not meet the pass mark. The total percentage pass is 76.70 %, showing a decrease in the overall performance for Marathi Language compared to 2024 which was 83.06%.

This report is primarily intended to support teachers by providing guidance to enhance students' reading, writing, comprehension and interpretative skills. It offers a clearer understanding of the objectives underpinning each question, enabling educators to better prepare and guide their learners. Educators' will obtain an elaborate overview of the expected objectives of the set questions which will result in preparing the candidates accordingly. Educators' should consult and analyse the detailed language specific explanations and illustrations to diagnose the strengths and weaknesses of the students as well as consider possible methods and ways of bettering the students' performances in the forthcoming years.

While many candidates have performed well on the basic and intermediate level tasks, there remains scope for development in higher order reading and extended writing skills. In vocabulary-based tasks most candidates demonstrated adequate knowledge and application of common everyday language. However spelling errors in simple words were frequently observed and many candidates struggled to employ varied and precise vocabulary where required. Writing continues to be the demanding component for most candidates.

Key messages

Candidates

should:

- Read extensively to broaden vocabulary and enhance overall language proficiency.
- Strengthen their understanding of key grammar areas including:
 - Correct use of pronouns (सर्वनाम)
 - Subject-verb agreement (कर्ता – कर्म – क्रियापद)
 - Adjectives (विशेषण)
 - Adverbs (क्रियाविशेषण)
 - Prepositions (शब्दयोगी अव्यये)
 - Exclamatory words (केवलप्रयोगी अव्यये)
- In Intermediate Reading (Question 4A), ensure that responses are strictly based on information provided in the text only. Also picking up answers indiscriminately should be avoided.
- In the Extended Reading task (Question 4B), most candidates need more practice to deal with higher-order reading skills like making inferences and using context to guess the meaning of unfamiliar words.
- In Questions 8 and 9, candidates need to develop writing skills by constructing well organized storylines paying attention to grammar, spelling and punctuation while varying sentence structures and using appropriate and precise vocabulary.

Specific Comments

QUESTION 1A

In this question, candidates are requested to identify the given pictures and write the name of the object accordingly. The pictures are given to the candidates and one example which was 'sparrow'. This question tests knowledge of basic vocabulary. The pictures of pen, ship, umbrella, rat and door were given. 1 mark is allocated for each correct answer.

For the image 'pen', most candidates wrote 'पेन' and 'लेखणी'. Some wrongly gave 'पेनसील', 'पेन', 'लेकणी', 'लेखाणी', as answers.

For the image 'ship' most candidates have written 'जहाज', 'बोट' and 'नाव'. Some candidates have even written 'वाहन' 'जाहज' or 'नळ'.

For the picture of 'umbrella', few candidates have succeeded in writing the correct answer which was 'छत्री'. Instead, many candidates have written 'चत्री' or 'पाऊस', 'चतरी'.

For the word 'उंदीर' 'rat', very few candidates have been able to write the word correctly.

Answers such as 'रात', 'मावूस', 'मावस' 'वाहन', 'मुरशख', 'नुंदीरमामा', 'उंदर' have been written.

For the image 'door' most candidates have been able to write the correct answer which was 'दर'/'दरवाजा'. Some candidates have written 'दर', 'दोर' also.

In this question, many candidates scored 0 out of 5 marks. It was noted that a few candidates have used English words for some pictures, whilst most candidates had difficulties in recalling and writing the appropriate words for the given images. Many candidates have made spelling mistakes while attempting to write the appropriate words. It was observed that candidates lack reading practice and proper handwriting. They failed to understand the correct meaning of the words.

Question 1B

This question is a matching exercise whereby 6 pictures are given, and candidates have to match the pictures with the given sentences. This question aims at assessing candidates' ability to read at a basic level by matching a sentence to its corresponding image.

One example is given. 1 mark is allocated for each good answer. Most of the candidates have been able to attempt the matching exercise successfully and scored 5 out of 5 marks. A few candidates scored 4 out of 5, whereby they had missed the third sentence from the matching exercise. Some candidates could not read with understanding and had difficulty in working out the question. Very few candidates could not match the sentences with the corresponding image. Some candidates matched the first sentence 'आई फुलझाडांना पाणी घालते' to the fourth picture given featuring a woman.

They most likely identified the word 'आई' and wrongly interpreted the matching for the above-mentioned sentence.

Question 2A

This question is set to test a series of grammatical structures through multiple choice items. The grammatical items assessed the application of tenses (present, past and future tense), prepositions, conjunction, pronouns, adjectives, etc. 1 mark is given for each good answer. Weak candidates had difficulties in choosing the right answer in order to complete the sentences. Very few candidates scored 10 marks.

The following items were challenging for candidates to attempt:

Item 1: हे _____ नवे घर आहे.

मामांचे. Many candidates have not been able to get the correct answer. Emphasis must be laid on there are suffixes (विभक्ती प्रत्यय) when there are adjectives in sentences.

Item 2: मुले शाळेच्या आवारात _____.

Most candidates gave the correct answer 'खेळतात'. This sentence seemed very familiar to them. Still a few candidates gave the wrong answer.

Item 3: रेवा _____ अंजू सैपाकघरात आहेत.

Many candidates answered 'आणि' which was the correct answer.

Item 4: काल बाबांनी मला शंभर रुपये _____.

Many candidates have put the wrong verbs. The right answer was 'दिले'. Some could not identify the different gender of the verbs.

Item 5: दादाला _____ सदरे खूप आवडतात.

Here the answer should have been 'पिवळे'. But Some candidates could not understand if the

word 'सदरे' is masculine singular 'हा' or masculine plural 'हे'. Such exercises have been included as from the lower primary textbooks. Therefore, candidates lack reading and practice skills. This should be highly encouraged in class.

Item 6: विनयची आजी _____ भाज्या विकते.

Most candidates gave the correct answer which was 'बाजारात'. Few candidates opted for the answer 'बाजारातून'.

For items 7, 8 and 9: Many candidates gave the correct answer.

Item 10

This was a challenging item as many candidates selected the wrong answer. Many candidates chose 'कोण' as it is a frequently used word. Hence, there is a need to lay emphasis on uses of interrogative pronouns. E.g. कोण/कोणी/ काय/कसे/कशी...

काल _____ कपडे धुतले होते?

Many candidates have not been able to give the correct answer 'कोणी'. This question had already appeared in the 2024 Examination Paper. Candidates' attention should have been drawn to prevent such mistakes from repeating.

Question 2B

This question is another multiple-choice exercise, where contextual vocabulary is being assessed. 1 mark is allocated for each correct answer. Most candidates answered all of them correctly.

Item 1: विद्यार्थी आपल्या _____ वह्या ठेवतो.

Some candidates have wrongly put the correct answer. Instead of writing 'दप्तरात' they have written 'खिडकीत' or 'पट्टीत'.

Item 2: लग्नाला जाण्यासाठी मिली नवा झगा _____.

This one was an easy and frequently used word. Thus, most of the candidates got it right.

Item 3: मीराने लवकर गृहपाठ _____ कारण तो सोपा होता.

Candidates could not differentiate the different verbs given to them. The verb 'केला' was to be inserted here. All the verbs given were very basic ones. 'केला', 'धुतला', 'टाकला', 'प्याला'. Candidates should be encouraged to identify and understand the different meaning of the various verbs.

Item 4: पक्ष्याने _____ आपले घरे बांधले.

Many candidates answered it correctly. 'झाडावर'.

Item 5: जेवण तयार करताना आई _____ भाज्या कापते.

A few candidates gave the wrong answer. They have written 'पळीने' instead of 'सुरीने'.

After analysis, it is recommended to emphasize grammar exercises incorporated with further practice of multiple-choice questions.

Question 3

A poster themed on the opening of a new shop named Mahima Joshi, was given. Candidates were required to read the poster with understanding and locate the correct information to answer the questions. As the questions set were within the reach of the candidates, many of them failed to give the correct answers for items 4 and 5 as well as item 9. The correct answers for the following items are as follows:

Item 1: महिमा जोशी नवे दुकान

Item 2: ३ नोव्हेंबर २०२५

Item 3: पाल्मा रोड, कात्रे बोरनला

Item 4: सकाळी ०९.३० वाजता.

Item 5: रात्री ०९.०० वाजता

Item 6: कपडे/ बूट/ घड्याळे

Item 7: दप्तर/ वह्या/ खेळणी

Item 8: काजेला पार्कला जाण्याची तिकिटे मिळतील

Item 9: सौ. महिमा जोशी यांना २१५१८२० या नंबरवर फोन करा.

In general, many candidates have been able to score maximum marks for this question.

However, it has been noticed that a few candidates had difficulty in reading and locating the answers and therefore, they scored very low marks or even did not answer any question. For items 4 and 5 many candidates could not give the correct opening time and closing time of the shop on specific days. Instead, they wrote the shop would be open from 09.30 in the morning till 5.00 in the evening from Monday to Friday. same for the time of closure on Saturday and Sunday instead of writing 9.00 at night, they gave the answer 10.00 in the morning till 9.00 at night.

It has been noted that many candidates do not have the notion of 'उघडणे' and 'बंद होणे'.

Candidates need more practice for such exercises and very close attention should be given to the question asked.

As for item 9, many candidates just wrote the phone number as answer which does not correspond to the question asked. Some candidates have also written ‘बट’ instead of ‘बूट’ and ‘घड्याळी’ instead ‘घड्याळे’.

As remedial, to improve functional reading and understanding skills in candidates, it is recommended to practice such exercises regularly with very close monitoring of Educators.

Question 4A

Question 4 consists of a narrative text set to assess candidates’ reading and understanding capabilities. The extended reading of the comprehension focuses on the candidates’ abilities of finding explicit information, identifying central themes and ideas, inference-based, analyzing aspects of character, following the chronology of events found in the extract.

This question assesses the candidates’ ability to read at an intermediate level and also assesses their ability to spot certain information in the passage. The overall performance for this exercise was satisfactory. Candidates have gained some basic reading skills and they were able to read and locate the answers from the passage and opted for the correct options.

Most of the candidates scored 3 marks out of 5. There were a few candidates who encountered difficulties while answering items 4 and 5 for the multiple choice. Candidates should be guided on how to spot and select the answers appropriately. Encouragingly, no candidate left the question unanswered.

Question 4B

This question evaluates the ability to read a longer piece of writing in Marathi. Very few candidates were able to answer all questions correctly. Candidates have given their best to answer the questions. It has been noted that some candidates had difficulties in answering items 3, 5 and 6; whilst some left some items unanswered. Some candidates applied the lifting method. Some candidates could not put the sentences in order according to the sequence of the passage. Very few candidates could not answer any questions. Some candidates left the whole section unanswered.

The following observations have been made:

Item 1: Most candidates have given the correct answer.

Item 2: Candidates have been able to spot the answer; yet many lifting has been noticed.

Item 3: Many candidates gave the correct answer.

Item 4: Some candidates gave the correct answer.

Items 5 & 6: Several candidates encountered difficulties while attempting these questions. Candidates could not understand the meaning of ‘कसे वाटले?’

Item 7: Many candidates have been able to spot the correct answer but some of them have used the lifting method. Some have missed the meaning of ‘काय ठरवले?’

Item 8: Very few candidates were able to write the correct sequence. Some wrote the answers in roman numerals instead of Marathi numerals.

It has also been noticed that a few candidates have not attempted to answer any question at all. Students should be trained and encouraged to read the comprehension with basic understanding and spot the correct answers. There is a real need for the candidates to improve their reading habits. Reading materials should be provided and questions should be prepared accordingly to give the candidates enough practice. Quite a few students encircle the correct answer, but they also fill in the blank space with the wrong answers. They should be properly guided to read the instructions given.

Question 5A

This question assesses candidates' knowledge of correct sentence structures and their ability to apply syntactic rules in Marathi through re-arranging jumbled words in proper syntax to formulate meaningful sentences.

Two marks are allocated for each meaningful and grammatically correct sentence. Almost, all candidates have been able to attempt this question.

Item 1:

Correct answers:

i. आईने एक नवा मोबाईल फोन विकत घेतला.

Incorrect answers:

- i. एक घेतला फोन मोबाईल विकत नवा आईने.
- ii. आईने एक नवा फोन मोबाईल विकत घेतला.

Item 2:

Correct answers:

- i. काल शिंप्याने राजूची विजार शिवून दिली.
- ii. काल राजूची विजार शिवून शिंप्याने दिली.
- iii. राजूची विजार काल शिंप्याने शिवून दिली.

Incorrect answers:

- i. दिली शिंप्याने राजूची विजार काल शिवून.
- ii. काल शिंप्याने राजूची शिवून विजार दिली.

It has been observed that a considerable number of candidates committed mistakes for the second item. Some even missed words while recopying them. Hence, it is advisable that more practice should be given on such types of exercises and special attention and focus should be given on correct sentence structure.

Question 5B

In this question, candidates were given a sentence completion task designed to assess their knowledge of syntax. They were provided with the beginning of each sentence and were required to complete them on their own. Many candidates attempted the task well; however numerous grammatical and spelling errors were observed in their syntax and sentence construction. Only few candidates scored full marks. Some did not conjugate the verbs properly, while others struggled with proper subject-verb agreement. There were many grammatical mistakes found in the syntax and sentence construction. In addition, several grammatical mistakes were noted, along with confusion in the use of gender for the proper nouns and words. Some of the related sentences are as follows:

Item 1: दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी ...

	Correct answers	Incorrect answers
१.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी घरी येते.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी पायचेंडू खेळतो.
२.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी आपल्या आजीकडे राहायला गेली.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी मैदानावर जातो.
३.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी आनंदाने घरी परतली.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी जेवण खातो आणि चेंडू खेळतो.
४.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी अभ्यास करते.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी घरी परततो.
५.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी आईबरोबर बाजाराला जाते.	दुपारी शाळेनंतर रजनी आंघोळ करतो.

Item 2: જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા ...

	Correct answers	Incorrect answers
૧.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા તી મિઠાઈ વિકત ઘેતે.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા તી તાજી ભાજી વિકત ઘેતલી.
૨.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા તી અનેક સામાન વિકત ઘેતે.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા તી મિઠાઈ વિકત ઘેતલી.
૩.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા તી પાવ વિકત ઘેતે.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા પાવ વિકતતે.
૪.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા તી તાજી ભાજી વિકત ઘેતે.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તે કેક વિકત ઘેતે.
૫.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા તી કેક વિકત ઘેતે.	જેવ્હા મીના દુકાનાત જાતે તેવ્હા મામા અનેક મિઠાઈ વિકત ઘેતાત.

Item 3: કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન ...

	Correct answers	Incorrect answers
૧.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તી મિઠાઈ ખાતે.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તે અનનસ ખાતે.
૨.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તી એક પાવ ખાતે.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તી એક લદુ ખાતે.
૩.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તી પાવભાજી ખાતે.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તે ખાલી પડતે.
૪.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તી ગરમ પોઢી ખાતે.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તી ગરમ દૂદ પિતે.
૫.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તી જેવળ ઘેતે.	કાકૂલા ભૂક લાગતે મ્હણૂન તે નૉહરી તયાર કરતો.

It has been observed that some candidates did not conjugate the verbs in the correct tenses. A few candidates have not attempted this question at all. Therefore, additional guidance and coaching should be extended to candidates in order to motivate the easy practice of such exercises.

Question 6

As a higher order reading task, this question aims at assessing the use of language. It requires the capability to reckon the fitting words based on the context of the extract and fill in the blanks with the appropriate words which are provided. Along with testing the reading skills, the use of language through cloze text exercise is also evaluated. The candidates are expected to read the text, then, choose the correct answers from the given words and fill in the given spaces.

Very few candidates interpreted the passage correctly and scored 10 marks.

Many candidates got confused with the first sentence ‘मी आजारी होते’ instead they wrote ‘मी घरी होते’. Similarly, ‘त्याने मला काही औषधे दिली’ they have written ‘त्याने मला काही सल्ला दिली’ which is the wrong answer. Candidates were unable to differentiate between masculine, feminine or neutral words as well as singular and plurals.

Overall, it can be concluded that most candidates did not get the gist of the extract and hence, they scored lower marks.

Question 7A

This question is a task which tests the use of language as well as the ability to formulate words which are grammatically correct and free from spelling mistakes according to the given context in order to fill in the gaps. Candidates are expected to demonstrate a substantial grasp of receptive and productive vocabulary and as such, they need to write down the correct form of the words. A satisfactory performance in this question was observed.

In this exercise, one wrong word is underlined in each sentence. Candidates should write the correct word formation in the space provided. Some candidates succeeded in writing the correct answers, but unfortunately, many candidates have wrongly written the words. Very few candidates have scored above 3 marks. The average has obtained marks between 0 to 3.

The following answers were recorded:

Item 1 – पाण्या, पाणि, पानी instead of correct answer पाणी

Item 2 – पिसव्या, पिसवस, पिसत instead of correct answer पिशवी

Item 3 – गुलाबी instead of correct answer गुलाब

Item 4 – भकरया, बकरी instead of correct answer भाकरी

Item 5 – खपाटात, कपाद instead of correct answer कपाट.

Question 7B

This question examines candidates' knowledge and abilities in the application of word transformation rules in Marathi. This question engages the candidates in transforming the given word from the bracket in a suitable one in order to fill in the gaps. Candidates require to display a good comprehension of the grammar and grammar rules while transforming the words.

Quite a few candidates scored full marks in this question. This implies that the majority still find it challenging to solve items testing word formation rules. Many candidates have wrongly written the words or some even did copy mistakes.

The following observations have been made:

Item 1 – गुणाची, गुती, गुणे instead of correct answer गुणी

Item 2 – निळी, निळे instead of correct answer निळा.

Item 3 – रस तेलु, तेला, instead of correct answer तेलकट

Item 4 – चवी चवा instead of correct answer चक्रदार

Item 5 – गंमता, गंमते instead of correct answer गमतीदार

Question 8

This question appraises candidates' capabilities of using simple cohesive devices such as adverbs of time, manner or place or coordinating conjunctions to write a short but coherent text. Five pictures are given with a pair of words alongside, respectively. Candidates are expected to formulate one sentence on each picture using the given words and also, ensure that the five sentences compose a coherent story.

In general, most of the candidates have been able to express themselves through well-developed sentences. A few have demonstrated their proficiency in the language. Some candidates have attempted to their level best, but have written the sentences with spelling and grammatical mistakes. Several candidates struggled a lot with vocabulary words, correct tenses, pronouns or even prepositions. A few of them incorrectly conjugated the verbs with a feminine subject. The pictures and pair of words given were very common and familiar to candidates, yet some candidates had left this exercise unanswered.

Examples of some sentences (for each pair of words):

Picture 1: एके दिवशी खेळणे

Correct answers	Incorrect answers
१. एके दिवशी रोहन चेंडू खेळत होता.	१. एके दिवशी राजू चेंदू खेळतो.
२. एके दिवशी राम आपल्या चेंडूने खेळत होता.	२. एके दिवशी मुलगी चेंडू खेळतो.
३. एके दिवशी अजय पायचेंडू खेळत होता.	३. एके दिवशी राल खेळणे.
४. एके दिवशी राज एक मुलगा चेंडू खेळतो.	४. एके दिवशी खेळतो.
५. एके दिवशी राज खेळतो.	५. आज सोमवारी आडे. म्मू दिवशी चेंडू खेळतो.

Picture 2: अचानक – पडणे

Correct answers	Incorrect answers
१. अचानक तो पडतो.	१. अचानक राजू पमीतवर पडतो.
२. अचानक तो खाली पडतो.	२. अचानक तो पडतो व जकमी घेतो.
३. अचानक राज पडतो.	३. अचानक लवकर छावताना राज पडतो.
४. अचानक तो चिखलावर घसरून खाली पडला.	४. अचानक राल पडतो.
५. अचानक तो पडला व तो जखमी झाला.	५. अचानक एक पडतो.

Picture 3: मग – रडणे

Correct answers	Incorrect answers
१. मग तो मोठ्याने रडू लागला.	१. मग आई रडतो.
२. मग तो रडतो.	२. मग तो मोठा रडतो.
३. मग तो खूप रडतो.	३. मग दिवशी रडते.
४. मग राजू रडत आहे.	४. मग तो हमसाहमशा रडू लागला.
५. मग तो मोठ्याने रडतो कारण तो जखमी होतो.	५. मग तो रडतो कारण तो जखमी घेतो.

Picture 4: काही वेळानंतर - मित्र

Correct answers	Incorrect answers
१. काही वेळानंतर एक मित्र राजला मदत करतो.	१. काही वेळानंतर राजूचे मित्र आणतात.
२. काही वेळानंतर त्याचा जिवलग मित्र त्याला उठवायला आला.	२. काही वेळानंतर तिचा मित्र येतो.
३. काही वेळानंतर त्याचा मित्र त्याला मदत करतो.	३. काही वेळानंतर त्यांचा मित्र राजू येतो व त्याला मदतो.
४. काही वेळानंतर त्याचा मित्र राज आला.	४. काही वेळानंतर, मित्र राल मदटा आहे.
५. काही वेळानंतर अजयचा मित्र राजू त्याला मदत करतो.	५. काही वेळानंतर मग मित्र जातो.

Picture 5: शेवटी – घरी

Correct answers	Incorrect answers
१. शेवटी त्याने रामला घरी नेले.	१. शेवटी तो राजूला मदत करतात आणि घरी परततो.
२. शेवटी दोन मित्र घरी जातात.	२. शेवटी घरी मग जातो.
३. शेवटी ते घरी जातात.	३. शेवटी तो घरी जातात.
४. ते शेवटी घरी जातात.	४. शेवटी तो राज घरी आणतो.
५. शेवटी त्याचा मित्र रामला घरी नेतो.	५. शेवटी राज व राजू घरी परतो.

It has been noted that candidates did not pay attention to the boy in the given pictures. A few of them incorrectly conjugated the verbs with a feminine subject accord. In some instances, it could be frequently noted that the candidates wrongly used the pronouns of 'ती' and 'ते' instead of 'तो'. Some candidates had wrongly copied the given words. Hence, it is advised that candidates be guided and taught how to write grammatically correct sentences using appropriate vocabulary. Imperatively, this implies that more emphasis should be laid on such

types of exercises and sentence writing.

Question 9

Question 9 is the composition writing task. This exercise requires the demonstration of the candidates' capabilities to write a coherent piece of continuous writing based on a guided canvas. This question is designed to appraise candidates' higher order writing skills, through a display of the following abilities to:

- elaborate a storyline creatively and coherently
- apply and utilize accurate grammar
- construct sentences with diverse structures
- communicate about their thoughts using rich and appropriate vocabulary.

Candidates are expected to write an essay of about 100 words. Only a few candidates succeeded in writing their essays correctly with good fluency and an ample use of good vocabulary and expressions.

1. Some candidates did not understand the word 'एकटा' and confused it with the word 'एकदा'. Some candidates omitted the word 'एकटा/एकटी' in their sentences. Instead they have written sentences like 'मी आणि माझी आई बाजाराला जातो.'
2. Many candidates could not figure out the meaning of the word 'माणसे', and they confused it, as the word 'मासे'. Educators are advised to familiarize candidates with such words so that they can easily differentiate almost similar words but with different meanings.
3. Many candidates did not understand the meaning of the term 'मदत मागणे' – 'to ask for help'. Several candidates misunderstood this term for 'मदत करणे' – 'to help'
4. Some candidates wrongly used 'घरी येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही'.

मी घरी येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही. Whereby the correct answer was 'मला घरी येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही.'

5. Some candidates missed the last item of the canvas which was ‘शेवटी काय होणे?’
6. Some candidates wrote very simple sentences with noticeable errors as they could not elaborate the ideas given in the canvas.
7. Quite a few candidates did not attempt this question at all, or they simply copied the canvas.
8. There were essays with many grammatical and spelling mistakes with a very limited range of vocabulary. Some of them wrote a long essay with irrelevant description and therefore lost their marks. Candidates should be encouraged at class level to attempt this type of task.

Other pertinent issues noted were:

- Lack of development of storyline
- Omission of instructions in the question given
- Linguistic issues including, inter alia:
 - Incoherence of tenses
 - Trouble with subject-verb agreement
 - Incorrect use of tenses
 - Errors in spelling and punctuation
 - Lack of a rich repertoire of vocabulary words
 - Inappropriate syntax due to the influence of English or French.

The following prompts were given:

दिलेल्या मुद्द्यांच्या आधारे सुमारे १०० शब्दांचा एक निबंध लिहा.

- | | | |
|------------------------------------|---|---------------------------------------|
| • एकटा/एकटी बाजाराला जाणे | - | To go to the market alone |
| • अनेक माणसे | - | Many people |
| • घरी परत येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही | - | Cannot find the way to come back home |
| • मदत मागणे | - | To ask for help |
| • शेवटी काय होणे? | - | What happened in the end? |

The following sample of essays is a specimen of the strengths and weaknesses encountered in the elapsed year's paper. The sampling is categorized as per the different marking bands. Errors have been underlined.

Essay 1

Band 1 (9-10 marks): Elaborate and well-developed story, G/S/P and syntax very accurate with very few errors written in an organized and coherent style.

आज शनिवार आहे. सायंकाळची वेळ आहे. रोहन नावाचा एक मुलगा, क्युरिपला राहतो. आज त्याची आई त्याला एकटा बाजाराला जायला सांगते कारण ती व्यस्त आहे व घरात एकही भाजी नाही. तेव्हा रोहन एक टोपली व पैसे घेऊन घरून निघतो. बाजारात अनेक माणसे आहेत. छोटा रोहन बाजारात शिरून आईने सर्व मागितलेल्या भाज्या विकत घेतो. सर्व मिळून त्याला आनंद वाटतो व तो बाजारातून निघतो. पण दुर्दैवाने त्याला घरी परत जाण्याचा रस्ता सापडत नाही. तो मनातल्या मनात घाबरतो म्हणून तो खाली बसून मदत मागू लागतो. अचानक त्याला त्याचा दादा त्याच्या दिशेने येताना दिसतो. तेव्हा रोहनला खूप आनंद होतो व त्याला मिठी मारतो. मग दादा म्हणतो, “चल! घरी जाऊया आई तुझी काळजी करत आहे.” अखेरीस दोघे मुलगे प्रसन्न मनाने घरी परततात.

Essay 2

Band 1 (9-10 marks): Elaborate and well-developed story, G/S/P and syntax very accurate with very few errors written in an organized and coherent style.

आज शाळेची सुट्टी व सेमवार आहे. हवामान फार छान आहे. मी एकटा बाजाराला जातो. काही वेळानंतर मी तेथे पोहोचतो. तेथे अनेक माणसे आहेत. मग मी ताज्या भाज्या विकत घेतो. नंतर मी घरी जातो. घरी परत येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही. मी काळजीत आहे. वेळ न लावता मी एका माणूस मदत मागतो. मी त्याला सर्व सांगतो. नंतर मी त्याला माझ्या बाबांचा फोन नंबर देतो. तो माझे बाबांना फोन करतो. मी माणूस सांजवळ आहे. काही वेळानंतर बाबा लवकर येतात. मी खूप आनंदात आहे. माझे बाबा माणूसाला आभार माणतो. मग मी बाबांनाला सर्व सांगतो. नंतर आम्ही घरी जातो.

Essay 3

Band 2 (6-8 marks): Quite developed story, G/S/P and syntax mostly accurate with a few errors written in an organized style.

ऐके सोमवारी श्री गणपत व त्यांचा छोटा मुलगा रवी पोर्ट लुईसच्या बाजाराला जातात. बाजार त्यांच्या घरापासून फार दूर नाही म्हणून ते चालताना जातात. नऊ वाजता ते बाजार पोहोचतात. बाजारात खूप माणसे आहेत. प्रथम रवीचे बाबा काही कपडे विकत घेतात मग ते दोन कप आईस्क्रीम घेतात. आईस्क्रीम खात असताना रवी गर्दीत. त्यांचे बाबा सापडत नाही. मग तो घरी परत येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही. तो रस्त्यावर बसतो व रडू लागतो. एक पोलीस ओफिसर त्याला पाहून चालत आहे. रवी त्याला मदत मागतो. पोलीस ओफिसर रवीला म्हणतो, “तुझ्या बाबांचे फोन नंबर काय आहे?”

मग तो श्री गणपत फोन करतो. श्री गणपत म्हणतात, “रवी कोठे आहे?” काही वेळानंतर श्री गणपत येतात व रवी खूप आनंद वाटतो. ते दोघे पोलीस ओफसर धन्यवाद केरून आनंदाने घरी परततात.

Essay 4

Band 2 (6-8 marks): Quite developed story, G/S/P and syntax mostly accurate with a few errors written in an organized style.

रविवारचा दिवस आहे. दिवस छान आहे. मी सकाळी लवकर उठते. नऊ वाजता मी एकटी बसने बाजाराला जाते. साडे नऊ वाजता मी बाजाराला पोहोते. बाजारात अने माणसे आहेत. मी सर्व भाज्या आणि फळे खरिदते. काही वेळानंतर मी घरी परत येण्यास पण मला सापडत नाही. मला खुप भिती वाटते. मी एक म्हातारा माणूसला मदत मागते. मी त्याला बोलते की “मी कात्रे बोर्नला राहाते.” तो मला सांगितो की ते बस तेथे जातात.” मी त्याला धन्यवाद देते आणि बसतून जाते. साडे दहा वाजता मी घरी परतते. घरात मी माझ्या पालकांना सर्व म्हणाते. त्या दिवसापासून मी एकटी बाजाराला जात नाही.

किती वाईत दिवस होता.

Essay 5

Band 2 (6-8 marks): Quite developed story, G/S/P and syntax mostly accurate with a few errors written in an organized style.

शाळेची सुट्टी आहे व सोमवारचा दिवस आहे. निळ्या आकाशात सूर्य चमकत आहे. सकाळची वेळ आहे. राजू नावाचा एक चांगला मुलगा आहे व तो लामारीला राहतो. राजू एकटा बाजाराला जातो व तो बसने बाजाराला जातो. सर्व तये तो अनेक माणसे दिसतो. राजू अनेक भाजी व फळे विकत घेतो. काही वेळानंतर राजू घरी परत येण्यास तो रस्ता सापडत नाही. एकाएकी राजू खाली पडतो व तो खूप रडतो. दुदैवाने एक चांगला म्हातारा राजूला मदत करतात. काही वेळानंतर राजू व म्हातारा घरी परततात व राजू म्हटाराला १००० रुपया देतो. शेवटी म्हातारा चांगला होतात व ते त्याचे घरी जातात.

“काय एक मजेदार दिवस आहे!”

Essay 6

Band 3 (3-5 marks): Basic story, G/S/P and syntax accurate enough with noticeable errors, accurate but simple vocabulary, written in an organized style.

आज सोमवार आहे. व सकाळची वेळ आहे. रजालेचा दिवस आहे. निळ्या आकाशात सूर्य चमकत आहे. मयंक एक चांगला मुलगा आहे. तो खूप आनंद आहे. कारण तो एकटा बाजाराला जातो. मयंक

पायी बाजाराला जातो. नऊ वाजता तो बाजाराला पोहोचतो. बाजारात अने का माणसे आहेत. मयंक अनेक भाज्या विकत घेतो. तो सफरचंद, किवी, संत्रे व केली विकत घेतो. मयंक दहा भज्या विकत घेतो व तो भज्या खातो. मयंक घरी परत येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही. मयंक पडत मागतो. साडे बारा वाजता तो घरी परततो व तो खूप आनंद आहे. मयंक भाज्या व फळे टोपलीत घालतो व तो चिकन ब्रियानी खातो व तो ती-व्हीवर चित्रपट पाहतो.

Essay 7

Band 4 (3-5 marks): Basic story, G/S/P and syntax accurate enough with noticeable errors, accurate but simple vocabulary, written in an organized style.

आज शनिवार आहे. आकाशात ऊन चमकत आहे. माझी आई मला बाजारातून भाज्या व फळे विकत घ्यायला सांगत आहे. मी चार पिशव्या घेतल्या आणि बाजाराच्या वाटेवर चलत आहे. मी बाजारातून अनेक ताजे भाज्या व फळे विकत घेत आहे. मी सफरचंद विकत घेत आहे. बाजारात अनेक माणसे आहेत. मी अता घरी परत जायचा रस्ता शेथेत आहे. पण मला घरी जायचा रस्ता सापडत नाही. मी खूप बीहीलो आहे. मी एका माणसाला मदत मागत आहे. मना तो माणूस मला मदत नाही करून गेला. तेव्हाच एका म्हातारा माणूस मला मदत करायला हेत आहे. तो मला माझ्या घराची वटा सांगतो. अता मी घराची वटेवर चालत आहे. घरी गेल्या वर मी आईला सगेले काही सागी.

मी त्या म्हातारया माणसाचे आभार माणतो!

Essay 8

Band 4 (1-2 marks): Basic story, G/S/P and syntax accurate enough with noticeable errors, accurate but simple vocabulary, written in an organized style.

एक दिवस रीता बाजाराला जाते. ती बस जाते. ती मिरची आणी बदादा विकत घेते. रीताच्या मामा अनेक माणसे विकत आहे. रीताने माणसे विकत घेते. ती आनंदानी खप घर जाते. ती घरी परत येण्यास. ती रडते. ती बोल “मदत, मदत!” माझी आई रस्ता जाते. ती मदत करते. आणि ती घरी जाते. शेवटी ती चहा देते. आणि ती डॉक्टरने बोल तुम्हाला पाय दूत आहे.

Essay 9

Band 4 (1-2 marks): Very basic story, with very little development, G/S/P and syntax erratic, vocabulary with disjointed writing.

रविवारीची आहे. मि लवकर उठते. मि दात घासते. मि आंघोळ करते. मि पाव खाते व चडा पिते. एकटी मी बाजाराला जाते. बाजारातला अनेक माणसे आहे. मि बाची विकत घेते. मि घरी जातात. मि घरी परत येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही. बाबा, आई, मावशी, मावश व भाऊ मदत मागणे.

Essay 10

Band 4 (1-2 marks): Basic story, G/S/P and syntax accurate enough with noticeable errors, accurate but simple vocabulary, written in an organized style.

आज सोमवार आहे. आजी लवकर उठते. ते दात घासते. ते देवाला नमस्काळ करते. आत १०.०० वाजता, आजी बाजाराला जाते. आत ११.०० वाजता आजी घरी परत येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही देले. आजी मदत मागते.

Essay 11

Band 5 (0 marks): Meaningless, and/or irrelevant.

आज मी एकटा/एकटी बाजाराला जाणे. बाजारात अनेक माणसे. घरी परत येण्यास रस्ता सापडत नाही. मदत मागणे. शेवटी काय होणे?

Conclusion

Educators are expected to act as a facilitator to identify and tackle areas which are problematic. By devising and making use of different innovative strategies and approaches, this aim can be achieved. This will in return be helpful and will encourage learning to take place in an enjoyable environment.

Recommendations

The following are recommendations made to facilitate and promote the teaching of Marathi language to students in primary schools:

- Educators should incorporate the use of new technological tools in class to make the class interesting and involve the students in different activities and attract their attention. They should create a better learning environment in classrooms by making use of interactive strategies.
- Additional attention should be focused on vocabulary, grammar and the application of sentence structuring in sentence writing.

All the capabilities and skills should be exploited fully while conducting the class. Students should be motivated to develop their listening and speaking skills by communicating in Marathi. Emphasis must be laid on practice of communication skills in class and amongst peers.

- Educators are encouraged to pay more attention to composition writing and initiate pupils to use effective adverbs and expressions in their composition.